custodian of the development of our strategic programme, I reiterate in very unambiguous terms that there is absolutely no question of sharing or allowing any foreign individual, entity or a state, any access to sensitive information about our nuclear assets.'

According to *The New Yorker*, the then CIA Director Leon Panetta had once said that the US does not know the location of Pakistan's nuclear weapons, then how could terrorists reach them (*The Daily Mail News*, 2010).

All six nuclear sites in Pakistan were protected by air defence, military, air force, ISI nuclear security division and other supporting civil agencies. ISI and IB conducted complete vetting of all employees working at these sites and in ancillary offices. Especially after the A.Q. Khan's proliferation fiasco, more elaborate and deeper security clearance and investigation process for all individuals working in sensitive positions or in nuclear facilities became mandatory (Holt & Gray, 2011).

Theoretically speaking, two terrorist organisations in Pakistan could be earmarked as threats to Pakistan's nukes or interested in dirty bombs, that is, Al Qaeda and TTP. But how intense and effective were their desire, plans and potential to achieve this goal needed to be scrutinised thoroughly. As far as TTP was concerned, it had neither shown any desire to gain access to Pakistan nukes nor had any plan come to notice of intelligence agencies to use a nuke or a dirty bomb. TTP was engaged in a tough tussle with the Pakistan Army in Waziristan and had earlier been smashed in Swat. It fought bloody battles with the armed forces and frequently killed/brutally beheaded the soldiers. It had no ideological following as well. Its cruel terrorist activities in urban centres of Pakistan, which resulted in hundreds of deaths and much destruction, made it a symbol of hate. Its penetration into army or other forces was highly unlikely. No doubt, it had potential to be destructive as it demonstrated with attacks on GHQ, Rawalpindi, Mehran naval base, Karachi and Kamra Airbase (16 August 2012). But in all these cases, the attacks were repulsed and assailants could not take away anything or anybody and were neutralised, arrested or killed. Therefore, odds are against TTP's potential to reach the nukes or the material. The threat further diminished in the absence of any record of its plans to acquire nukes or make a dirty bomb.

Al Qaeda had its presence felt in Pakistan. It had a desire and plans to have some sort of dirty bomb or even a nuke. But it had been under